

Clara Xu

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EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania Master of Applied Economics and Data Science (MAEDS)	<i>Sep. 2026 - Dec. 2027</i>
Nanjing University B.A. in Japanese; Minor in Financial Engineering (WES GPA: 3.9/4.0)	<i>Sep. 2022 - Jun. 2026</i>
The University of Tokyo Exchange Program	<i>Oct. 2024 - Mar. 2025</i>

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BNP Paribas <i>Intern, Corporate Coverage</i> Shanghai, China	<i>Feb. 2026 - May 2026</i>
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- Produced industry research on the global automotive and EV sector, tracking cross-border strategic investments and partnerships involving major Chinese OEMs to map how trade and industrial policy shifts are reshaping supply chains
- Assessed sanctions exposure by researching corporate footprints across restricted areas, and monitored regulatory and ESG developments, building a working view of how geopolitical and policy risk feeds into counterparty risk
- Monitored negative news and company responses for a cross-border fast fashion e-commerce platform, identified key risk areas, assessed risk trends and potential impacts, and prepared reports to support client relationship management

Boston Consulting Group <i>Part-time Assistant</i>	<i>Dec. 2024 - Apr. 2025</i>
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- Contributed to a Go-to-Market project for a high-end audio company by analyzing how pre- vs. post-pandemic macroeconomic conditions in Saudi Arabia and the UAE shaped consumer demand recovery
- Sized the addressable market using a bottom-up approach by surveying 2,000+ potential venues (theaters, stadiums, and educational institutions); triangulated estimates with government infrastructure plans, megaproject pipelines, and channel interviews to estimate a ~US\$300M market and assess growth potential across two Gulf economies
- Interviewed industry leaders and synthesized insights on local consumption patterns and distribution channels, revealing a distribution ecosystem characterized by strong reliance on local distributors and project-based sales

Shanghai Guotai Haitong Securities Asset Management Co., Ltd. <i>Assistant Fund Manager</i>	<i>Jul. 2024 - Aug. 2024</i>
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- Built a Python-based Brinson performance attribution model on a five-year holding history of an agriculture-themed fund, isolating how sector allocation vs. security selection drove performance
- Authored 8 weekly sector reports using Wind and broker research to support top-down overweight/underweight sector calls for FOF product research, contributing to sector allocation discussions
- Drafted and refined 20+ roadshow reports spanning industry fundamentals, bond funds, and equity funds, translating macro and sector views for investor audiences

Guosen Securities Co., Ltd. <i>Assistant Researcher, Liquor Sector Research Department</i>	<i>Jan. 2024 - Jun. 2024</i>
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- Reviewed 38 dealer and manufacturer meeting notes, analyzed channel inventory, wholesale pricing, and sell-through trends to identify leading indicators ahead of financial results
- Drafted three industry outlook reports, one in-depth research report, and five weekly reports, integrating industry trends, channel dynamics, and company fundamentals to formulate investment views
- Independently authored a 13-page initiation report on Tianyoude Highland Barley Spirits, conducting fundamental analysis, earnings forecasting, and valuation based on financial performance and industry trends

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Analysis of ESG Disclosure and Firm Value in Chinese Listed Companies with LLM	<i>Nov. 2023 - Dec. 2025</i>
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- Built a corporate ESG disclosure database in Python covering 20,000+ CSR reports published by Chinese listed companies (2019-2023) to enable systematic, large-scale text analysis of disclosure quality
- Designed and implemented an LLM-based extraction pipeline to construct 20+ standardized ESG indicators, improving the consistency and reproducibility of downstream quantitative analysis
- Built a PCA-based ESG disclosure quality index and conducted panel regression analysis in Stata, demonstrating a positive association between ESG disclosure quality and firm profitability

Income Inequality and the Realization of Fertility Desires in China	<i>Feb. 2025 - Jun. 2025</i>
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- Analyzed six waves of China General Social Survey (CGSS) data from 2013-2023 (17,355 observations) to test whether income inequality widens the gap between desired and realized fertility
- Built two-way fixed-effects regression models with robustness checks, finding that widening income inequality significantly enlarges the fertility gap via relative deprivation and subjective socioeconomic status
- Ran heterogeneity analyses showing the effect concentrates among eastern, urban, individuals in their 30s, and used the results to propose targeted policy responses to China's low fertility challenge
- Accepted by *International Conference on Economic Management and Green Development (ICEMGD)*

SKILLS

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- Language Skills: Mandarin (Native), Japanese (N1), English (Professional: TOEFL 107/120, GRE 329)
 - Skills: Python, R, Stata, SQL, Wind, iFinD